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# PRIMA LA VIDA!

Jorge Martin became the **first rider** from an independent team to win the championship in the modern MotoGP era.

Kavita Menon

kavita.menon@thehindu.co.in

**A**t the final winners' ceremony of the 2024 MotoGP season, two-time world champion Francesco Bagnaia stood atop the podium — alongside Marc Marquez and Jorge Martin — after winning the Solidarity Grand Prix in Barcelona, Spain. The Italian anthem echoed along the main straight as teams and spectators watched the top three riders one last time this year.

But there was a bright, wide smile spread across Martin's face, despite standing on the third step. Everyone knew what it meant. The Spaniard, who started the race in fourth, had achieved what he had set out to do at the beginning of this season. **After 20 thrilling races, Prima Pramac's Martin was crowned the 2024 MotoGP World Champion, with a 10-point advantage over Bagnaia.**

There were joyous celebrations and raw emotions as the 26-year-old crossed the finish line, becoming the first rider from an independent team to win the championship in the modern MotoGP era. [An independent team, like Prima Pramac Racing, partners with a factory, such as Ducati, to use their bikes and technology].

Martin held his nerve when it mattered most, delivering an error-free weekend to secure his maiden crown while denying his rival a third successive one.

What began as yet another season of 'The Rematch' (a term used to describe a high-stakes showdown between two contenders for the championship) kept fans on the edge

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**Dream come true:** This was Martin's maiden MotoGP crown. Defending champion Francesco Bagnaia came second in the standings. REUTERS